

C07 · COURAGE

The Permission Slip

Vulnerability and the Courage to Be Seen

The Permission Slip

Sign permission to be unfinished in one specific way. Your partner may hear the sentence. They do not grant it.

1. Glance at the menu or ignore it: imperfect, playful, uncertain, ambitious, needy, emotionally open. Draft in silence.
2. Standard shape: I give myself permission to be [one way] when [a real situation], and I will stop requiring [one self-demand] of myself this week.
3. Read it to yourself. If their body, time, or money is the object, keep the permission and set the request aside. A later request can be declined.
4. Read aloud only if you want to. The witness says what they heard, then stops. They do not rewrite it or grant it. Then swap. A card may stay unread.

Done when each person who wanted a slip has signed one or chosen not to show it.

You may pass, pocket the card, or change the word. One honest permission is enough.